horses and riding, and we'd drop off to sleep about ten or eleven.

A month or so after the inauguration, we invited Tip O'Neill and his wife and a few other guests to have dinner with us in the family quarters. Nancy had already made a lot of progress in her efforts to renovate the second and third floors, and Tip said, "You know, I have been in and out of this place for twenty-seven years and I have never seen it look as beautiful as this."

It was a warm, pleasant evening, and a good time was had by all. By the time it was over, I was certain Tip and I had worn out Nancy and the other guests by trying to top each other with Irish stories passed on by our fathers. I also thought I'd made a friend. But a day or two later, I picked up a newspaper and read a story in which Tip really lit into me personally because he didn't like the economic recovery program and some of the cuts I proposed in spending.

Some of his remarks were pretty nasty. I was not only surprised but disappointed and also a little hurt. I called him and said, "Tip, I just read in the paper what you said about me yesterday. I thought we had a pretty fine relationship going . . ."

"Ol' buddy," Tip said, "that's politics. After six o'clock we can be friends; but before six, it's politics."

Tip was an old-fashioned pol: He could be sincere and friendly when he wanted to be, but when it came to the things he believed in, he could turn off his charm and friendship like a light switch and become as bloodthirsty as a piranha. He was a politician and a Democrat to his roots. Until six o'clock, I was the enemy and he never let me forget it. So, after a while, whenever I'd run into him, whatever time it was, I'd say, "Look, Tip, I'm resetting my watch; it's six o'clock."